

Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL) Assessment

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Introduction

Activities of daily living (ADL) are the functional tasks of everyday life, oriented toward caring for one's own body. Activities of daily living may also be referred to as basic activities of daily living (BADL). Instrumental activities of daily living (IADL) are complex activities that support daily life in the home and community. Physical, cognitive, or emotional deficits may impair the ability to perform ADL or IADL. When people are unable to perform one or more of these activities, they may need assistance from other people, equipment/devices, or both. Inability to perform these tasks and dependency on others for their completion may diminish a patient's self-concept.(1)(2)

Variations in cognitive function, visual impairment, lower perceived well-being, pain, and sleep disturbance are variables associated with a patient's ability to complete daily activities. All variables and fluctuations should be taken into consideration when planning treatment programs to restore daily activity function.(1)(3)

Assessment of the patient's ability to perform ADL or IADL is an important factor in determining the amount and type of services that are required, as well as the ability to remain at home.(4) The following assessment outlines the range of functional abilities within specific ADL and IADL based on standardized assessment instruments.(1)(2)(3)(5)(6)

Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living Assessment (IADL)

- **Activities of Daily Living.** Check all that apply.
 - **Personal Hygiene and Grooming:** Ability to tend to personal hygiene needs (eg, washing face and hands, hair care, shaving, teeth or denture care, fingernail care)
 - Patient is able to groom self unaided, with or without use of assistive devices or adapted methods.
 - Grooming utensils or assistive devices must be placed within reach before patient is able to complete grooming activities.
 - Someone must assist patient to groom self.
 - Patient depends entirely upon someone else for grooming needs.
 - Patient actively negates all efforts of others to maintain grooming.
 - **Upper Body Dressing:** Ability (with or without dressing aids), including undergarments, pullovers, front-opening shirts and blouses, managing zippers, buttons, and snaps
 - Patient is able to get clothes out of closets and drawers, put them on, and remove them from upper body without assistance.
 - Patient is able to dress upper body without assistance if clothing is laid out or handed to patient.
 - Someone must help patient put on upper-body clothing.
 - Patient depends entirely upon another person to dress upper body and cooperates with efforts of others to help.
 - Patient depends entirely upon another person to dress upper body but resists efforts of others to help.
 - **Lower Body Dressing:** Ability (with or without dressing aids), including undergarments, slacks, socks or nylons, shoes
 - Patient is able to obtain, put on, and remove clothing and shoes without assistance.
 - Patient is able to dress lower body without assistance if clothing and shoes are laid out or handed to patient.
 - Someone must help patient put on undergarments, slacks, socks or nylons, and shoes.
 - Patient depends entirely upon another person to dress lower body and cooperates with efforts of others to help.
 - Patient depends entirely upon another person to dress lower body but resists efforts of others to help.
 - **Bathing or Showering:** Ability to wash entire body. **Excludes grooming (washing face and hands only)**
 - Patient is able to bathe self in shower or tub independently.
 - Patient is able to bathe self in shower or tub independently with use of devices.
 - Patient is able to bathe in shower or tub with assistance of another person (a) for intermittent supervision or encouragement or reminders, **OR** (b) to get in and out of shower or tub, **OR** (c) for washing difficult-to-reach areas.

- Patient is able to participate in bathing self in shower or tub, but requires presence of another person throughout bath for assistance or supervision.
- Patient is unable to use shower or tub and is bathed in bed or bedside chair.
- Patient is unable to effectively participate in bathing and is totally bathed by another person and is cooperative with those who bathe them.
- Patient is unable to effectively participate in bathing and is totally bathed by another person but resists efforts to keep themselves clean.
- **Toileting:** Ability to get to and from toilet or bedside commode
 - Patient is able to get to and from toilet independently, with or without a device.
 - Patient is able to get to and from toilet when reminded, assisted, or supervised by another person.
 - Patient is unable to get to and from toilet, but is able to use a bedside commode (with or without assistance).
 - Patient is unable to get to and from toilet or bedside commode but is able to use bedpan or urinal independently.
 - Patient is totally dependent in toileting but indicates the need to go.
 - Patient is totally dependent in toileting and does not alert for assistance to go.
- **Transferring:**
 - Patient is able to transfer independently.
 - Patient transfers with minimal human assistance or with use of assistive device.
 - Patient is unable to transfer self, but is able to bear weight and pivot during transfer process.
 - Patient is unable to transfer self, and is unable to bear weight or pivot when transferred by another person.
 - Patient is bedfast, unable to transfer, but is able to turn and position self in bed.
 - Patient is bedfast, unable to transfer, and is unable to turn and position self.
- **Ambulation or Locomotion:** Ability to **safely** walk, once in standing position, or use wheelchair, once in seated position, on variety of surfaces
 - Patient is able to independently walk on even and uneven surfaces and climb stairs with or without railings (ie, needs no human assistance or assistive device).
 - Patient requires use of device (eg, cane, walker) to walk alone OR requires human supervision or assistance to negotiate stairs or steps or uneven surfaces.
 - Patient is able to walk only with supervision or assistance of another person at all times.
 - Patient is chairfast, unable to ambulate, but is able to wheel self independently.
 - Patient is chairfast, unable to ambulate, and is unable to wheel self.
 - Patient is bedfast and unable to ambulate or be up in a chair.
- **Feeding or Eating:** Ability to feed self meals and snacks. **NOTE: This refers only to the process of eating, chewing, and swallowing, not preparing food to be eaten.**
 - Patient is able to independently feed self.
 - Patient is able to feed self independently but requires (a) meal set up, **OR** (b) intermittent assistance or supervision from another person, **OR** (c) a liquid, or pureed or ground meat diet.
 - Patient is unable to feed self and must be assisted or supervised throughout meal or snack.
 - Patient is able to take in nutrients orally **AND** receives supplemental nutrients through nasogastric tube or gastrostomy.
 - Patient is unable to take in nutrients orally and is fed nutrients through nasogastric tube or gastrostomy.
 - Patient is unable to take in nutrients orally or by tube feeding.
- **Instrumental Activities of Daily Living.** Check all that apply.
 - **Planning and Preparing Light Meals:** (eg, cereal, sandwich) or reheating delivered meals
 - Patient is (a) able to independently plan and prepare all light meals for self or reheat delivered meals, **OR** (b) physically, cognitively, and mentally able to prepare light meals on regular basis but has not routinely performed light meal preparation in the past (ie, prior to this admission).
 - Patient is unable to prepare light meals on regular basis due to physical, cognitive, or mental limitations.
 - Patient is unable to prepare any light meals or reheat any delivered meals.
 - **Transportation:** Physical and mental ability to **SAFELY** use car, taxi, or public transportation (bus, train, subway)
 - Patient is able to independently drive a regular or adapted car, **OR** uses regular or handicap-accessible public bus.
 - Patient is able to ride in car only when driven by another person, **OR** is able to use bus or van for the disabled only when assisted or accompanied by another person.
 - Patient is unable to ride in car, taxi, bus, or van, and requires transportation by ambulance.
 - **Laundry:** Ability to do own laundry (ie, to carry laundry to and from washing machine, to use washer and dryer, to wash small items by hand)
 - Patient is (a) able to independently take care of all laundry tasks, **OR** (b) physically, cognitively, and mentally able to do laundry and access facilities, but has not routinely performed laundry tasks in the past (ie, prior to this admission).
 - Patient is able to do only light laundry, such as minor hand wash or light washer loads due to physical, cognitive, or mental limitations; needs assistance with heavy laundry, such as carrying large loads of laundry.
 - Patient is unable to do any laundry due to physical limitation, or needs continual supervision and assistance due to cognitive or mental limitations.
 - **Housekeeping:**

- Patient is (a) able to independently perform all housekeeping tasks, **OR** (b) physically, cognitively, and mentally able to perform ALL housekeeping tasks but has not routinely participated in housekeeping tasks in the past (ie, prior to this admission).
- Patient is able to perform only light housekeeping tasks (eg, dusting, wiping kitchen counters) independently.
- Patient is able to perform housekeeping tasks with intermittent assistance or supervision from another person.
- Patient is unable to consistently perform any housekeeping tasks unless assisted by another person throughout process.
- Patient is unable to effectively participate in any housekeeping tasks.
- **Shopping:** Ability to plan for, select, and purchase items in store and to carry them home or arrange delivery
 - Patient is (a) able to plan for shopping needs and independently perform shopping tasks, including carrying packages, **OR** (b) physically, cognitively, and mentally able to take care of shopping, but has not done shopping in the past (ie, prior to this admission).
 - Patient is able to go shopping but needs some assistance: (a) able to do only light shopping and carry small packages by self, but needs someone to do occasional major shopping, **OR** (b) unable to go shopping alone, but can go with someone to assist.
 - Patient is unable to go shopping, but is able to identify items needed, place orders, and arrange home delivery.
 - Patient needs someone to do all shopping and errands.
- **Ability to Use Telephone:** Ability to answer phone, dial numbers, and effectively use telephone to communicate
 - Patient is able to dial numbers and answer calls appropriately and as desired.
 - Patient is able to use specially adapted telephone (ie, large numbers on dial, teletype phone for the deaf) and call essential numbers.
 - Patient is able to answer telephone and carry on normal conversation but has difficulty with placing calls.
 - Patient is able to answer telephone only some of the time or able to carry on only limited conversation.
 - Patient is unable to answer telephone at all, but can listen if assisted with equipment.
 - Patient is totally unable to use telephone.
 - Patient does not have telephone or cell phone.
- **Management of Oral Medications:** Patient's ability to prepare and take all prescribed oral medications reliably and safely, including administration of correct dosage at appropriate times and intervals. **NOTE: This refers to ability, not adherence or willingness. It excludes inhalant or mist, injectable, and IV medications.**
 - Patient is able to independently take correct oral medication(s) and proper dosage(s) at correct times.
 - Patient is able to take medication(s) at correct times if: (a) individual doses are prepared in advance by another person, **OR** (b) given daily reminders, **OR** (c) someone develops a drug diary or chart.
 - Patient is unable to take medication unless administered by someone else.
 - Patient has not been prescribed any oral medication.
- **Management of Inhalant or Mist Medications:** Patient's ability to prepare and take all prescribed inhalant or mist medications (nebulizers, metered dose devices) reliably and safely, including administration of correct dosage at appropriate times or intervals. **NOTE: This refers to ability, not adherence or willingness. It excludes all other forms of medication (oral tablets, injectable, and IV medications).**
 - Patient is able to independently take correct medication and proper dosage at correct times.
 - Patient is able to take medication at correct times if: (a) individual doses are prepared in advance by another person, **OR** (b) given daily reminders.
 - Patient is unable to take medication unless administered by someone else.
 - Patient has not been prescribed any inhalant or mist medication.
- **Management of Injectable Medications:** Patient's ability to prepare and take all prescribed injectable medications reliably and safely, including administration of correct dosage at appropriate times or intervals. **NOTE: This refers to ability, not adherence or willingness. It excludes IV medications.**
 - Patient is able to independently take correct medication and proper dosage at correct times.
 - Patient is able to take injectable medication at correct times if: (a) individual syringes are prepared in advance by another person; **OR** (b) given daily reminders.
 - Patient is unable to take injectable medications unless administered by someone else.
 - Patient has not been prescribed any injectable medication.
- **Patient Management of Equipment (includes ONLY oxygen, intravenous or infusion therapy, enteral or parenteral nutrition equipment or supplies):** Patient's ability to set up, monitor, and change equipment reliably and safely; add appropriate fluids or medication; clean, store, and dispose of equipment or supplies using proper technique. **NOTE: This refers to ability, not adherence or willingness.**
 - Patient manages all tasks related to equipment completely independently.
 - If someone else sets up equipment (ie, fills portable oxygen tank, provides patient with prepared solutions), patient is able to manage all other aspects of equipment.
 - Patient requires considerable assistance from another person to manage equipment, but independently completes portions of task.
 - Patient is only able to monitor equipment (eg, liter flow, fluid in bag) and must call someone else to manage equipment.
 - Patient is completely dependent on someone else to manage all equipment.
 - Patient does not utilize any equipment for management of condition.

- **Caregiver Management of Equipment (includes ONLY oxygen, intravenous or infusion therapy, enteral or parenteral nutrition, and ventilator therapy):** Caregiver's ability to set up, monitor, and change equipment reliably and safely; add appropriate fluids or medication; clean, store, and dispose of equipment or supplies using proper technique. **NOTE: This refers to ability, not adherence or willingness.**
 - Caregiver manages all tasks related to equipment completely independently.
 - If someone else sets up equipment, caregiver is able to manage all other aspects of equipment.
 - Caregiver requires considerable assistance from another person to manage equipment, but independently completes significant portions of task.
 - Caregiver is only able to complete small portions of task (eg, administer nebulizer treatment; clean, store, or dispose of equipment or supplies).
 - Caregiver is completely dependent on someone else to manage all equipment.
 - No equipment is utilized for management of condition.

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